



St. Patrick's GAA Donabate – U13 Boys Football 2020 Plan

“Focus on Performance & Development, not Results”

Main High Level Goals

- ✓ **Player Development** – Skills, Movement, Fitness & Enjoyment.
- ✓ **Player Retention** – Sustain playing numbers to ensure 2 teams in 2021.
- ✓ **Bi-Lateral Focus** – Key focus area again this year but at more of a ‘match pace’.
- ✓ **Positional Sense / Specialist Coaching** – Players understand various positions.

Development Needs and Player Pathway

Player Pathway: GAA initiative to help guide coaches, mentors, parents etc re the development of the players. It is flexible as kids develop at different rates and stages but it aims to give young players the best opportunity to succeed at whatever level they may play and reach their full potential **“doing the right thing, at the right time and in the right way”**.

Our players will be aged 12-13 through 2020 and will make the move toward the fourth stage (of five) on the Pathway which is called **‘Learning about Positions’** (13-15 year olds). We will continue to work on key elements of the previous stage (Learning to Play Together’) with an emphasis continuing on providing players with an understanding of how to play and work together as a team.

With the move to 15 a side / full pitch football, stage 4 with a **key focus around learning about positions and understanding the principles of attack and defence** (creating and denying space) it is well aligned with U13 football and as previous years our **plans will be aligned** to player pathway.

Playing Rule Changes: Rule changes going to U13 are significant with **the boys basically moving to the ‘full’ rules**. Key rule changes have recently been implemented in football and we communicated these recently so will not repeat in full here. Part of the transition to U13 will be to get used to all the rules and also no longer being restricted in terms of the number of plays they can take. Their development around when it is right to run the ball / use the unlimited plays, release or kick the ball will continue at U13 (at U12 they had a max of 4 plays and 2 plays for all years prior to that).

Encouraging the kids to be a **‘Head up’ player** will continue, this **“scan the pitch”** approach allows them to see their options. **“Terminology”** sheet we done up last year will be updated and issued.

Core Development / Focus Areas 2020

As in 2019 training will continue to heavily focus on a “small sided, games based” approach and also incorporate the right level of basic, more drill like ‘activities’. In 2019 we blended sessions to ensure the ‘games based’ approach was a key focus but so too was continued basic skill building.

Skill Emphasis - Review	Physical Focus
• Bi-lateral focus in all sessions. More games based in 2020. • ‘Simple/Stupid’ approach to regular skill focus - checking the basics. • ‘Knowing when to’ hand, fist or kick pass. • Blocking, NHTs & High Catch were noted 2019 skill improvement areas. Despite progress, same continues. No ‘new’ Skills as such. Focus is on refining the ‘newer’ ones (e.g. hook kicking), becoming better at ones noted above, bi-lateral on the basics & linking them together (team-play).	• Strength – own body weight & core exercises (introduced slowly in 2019). • Speed – reaction sprints & fun relays (within standard sessions). • Stamina - with the ball / circuit training / skills under fatigue. • Flexibility / Balance continued and get GPO to assess players re greatest need for additional work. • Ensure match warm ups planned and cool downs become standard. <i>Above elements will cross both the Athletic Development Sessions and stand Training.</i>
Game Sense / Decision Making	Patterns of Play
• Continued development via games based training. • Ensure clear learning outcomes are part of each session plan. • Feedback sought from current & former players and other mentors re match day coaching / team prep. • Feedback from same groups re player decision making, movement / attacking the ball etc.	• Kick Outs – A no. of alternatives and <u>players understand their roles</u>. • Set plays; 45s, side-lines, frees etc. Give players options & allow improvisation. • Defending set plays, reacting to kick-outs, ready for all set plays and re-starts (re-set), marks etc. • General play - providing different options, plays and develop a greater understanding of the game & options.
Positional Sense	Child Development re Health & Performance
• ‘Developing’ positional sense will be a key focus on full pitch / 15 a side game. • Session support from older St Pat’s players re key attributes of positions. • Regular, formal keeper coaching sessions using club expertise. • Standard sessions brings in extra keeper ‘work’ – this has worked.	• Aim: kids continue to enjoy their training & matches whilst developing as kids and players. • Continued adherence to GAA Respect Initiative. • Focus on Performance & Development of the kids, not the results. • Aid kids understanding of match preparation from general diet to match prep & recovery re food and hydration.

Main Delivery of Learning / Development

Grading Games

7 games (per team) to be completed from **Feb 8th to April 25th**. Games at CCC2 can't be deferred, can only be brought forward. All fixtures issued to Parents on group.

League Games

9 games (per team) to be completed from **May 09th to Oct 17th**. Majority of games are before the summer and if the weather is good we'll look to add in friendly matches and play in tournaments if possible (Drogheda invite a possibility for both teams and Naomh Mearnog have invited Team 1 to a **competition on May 30th**). All fixtures issued to Parents on group.

Strength, Conditioning & Athletic Development

We started Athletic Development sessions in **May 2019 with Niall Franklin / Chippy** for a 6 week trial period and ended up completing 14 sessions over the year. They went well and I think we can see the improvements in the way the lads are moving in training and on the pitch.

2020 Plan is to complete a similar number of sessions which are front loaded to pre-summer (as 75% of our competitive matches are pre-summer). Strength sessions have been undertaken and the lads are now moving toward the conditioning side and overall the emphasis is 'Athletic Development'.

Our own **training sessions have a big focus on match specific 'movements'** and ensuring the boys are warming up and stretching appropriately. This continues through 2020.

I'd like to possibly get some coaches in from other disciplines (example basketball and athletics) and not just for on Athletic Development but also 'patterns of play', team work, communications etc).

'Guest' Coaches

Didn't happen last year (had Team 1 watched 3 times for feedback) but I will re-visit this as the kids will benefit from different ideas and voices. One idea to support this is looking at a **2 day Easter Camp** for U13-14s where we will **recruit external coaches** (Dublin County Board / other club's GPOs)

Weekly and Semester Coaching Plans

Sessions plans are **distributed for each training session** with learning outcomes included. Need to get the **annual plan / aims broken down into 3 semesters**. This didn't happen in 2019 but needs to be included for 2020. Coaching group to meet to agree same with 3 semesters being Feb to April, May to July and Aug to Oct (summer break will be shorter this year and then finish earlier).

Coaching Language

Language we use with the kids and how we coach continues to be very important. We'll **update the 2019 document** we compiled last year to ensure consistent messaging to the kids. This year we'll open this out to other coaching groups for their ideas.